Defining Your Customer Before Your Customer Defines You

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Today's Big Question

Why should someone buy from you — and more importantly, who is that someone?

If your target audience is **everyone**, your actual target audience is probably **no one**.

We'll Solve Two Problems Today

WHO should I sell to?

WHY should they choose me?



Meet Our Imaginary Founder: Rohan

Rohan just launched a healthy snack brand: **FitFataak** — baked, high protein, low oil, ₹60/pack, available online, with Indian namkeen-style flavours.

Rohan proudly announces: *"My target audience is people who like snacks."* Technically correct. Marketing-wise — useless.

16-year-old student

Wants tasty + cheap

28-year-old gym enthusiast

Wants protein + performance

40-year-old manager

Wants convenience + health

Netflix at 2 AM

Wants anything crunchy

They all eat snacks. But they don't buy them for the **same reason**.

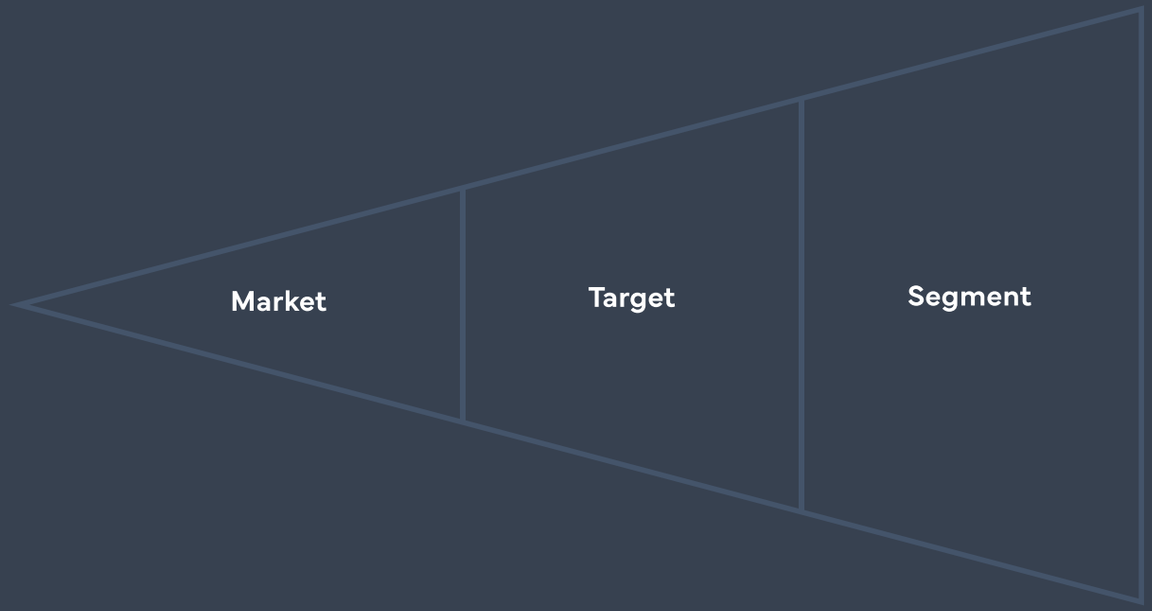




Marketing Starts With a Choice

> Marketing is partly the art of saying: "I want **these** customers more than I want **those** customers."

Because businesses have limited money, time, advertising budgets, distribution, and attention. You cannot communicate differently to 1.4 billion people.



This is where **STP** comes in.

STP in One Slide

Segmentation

Divide the market into meaningful groups. *Who exists?*

Targeting

Choose which group you want to win. *Who do I want?*

Positioning

Decide what that group should remember about you. *What should they think about me?*

Three simple verbs: **Divide → Choose → Own**

Why STP Exists

Generic Ad

> "Delicious snacks for everyone. Healthy, tasty and affordable."

Nothing wrong with it. And that's the problem — it could describe hundreds of brands.

Specific Ad

> "The 4 PM office snack with 15g protein that doesn't leave you guilty before dinner."

Suddenly you can visualise exactly who this is for: a health-conscious working professional who gets hungry in the evening.

Specificity makes marketing stronger.

How Can We Segment Customers?

Four Classic Lenses

1	**Demographic** **Who are they?** Age, income, gender, occupation, education, family stage. *Example: Working professionals aged 25–40.*
2	**Geographic** **Where are they?** Country, city tier, region, urban/rural. *Example: Consumers in metro Indian cities.*
3	**Psychographic** **How do they think?** Lifestyle, aspirations, values, interests. *Example: "I want to eat healthier, but not boiled broccoli every evening."*
4	**Behavioural** **What do they do?** Usage, frequency, benefits sought, occasion. *Example: People who regularly snack between 4–6 PM.*



Segmentation Lens #2: Geographic



Where Are They?

- Country / City
- Tier (metro, Tier 2, Tier 3)
- Region
- Climate
- Urban vs. rural

Example: Consumers living in metro Indian cities — Mumbai, Bengaluru, Delhi, Hyderabad.

Segmentation Lens #3: Psychographic



How Do They Think?

- Lifestyle & aspirations
- Values & beliefs
- Interests & hobbies
- Attitude toward health, money, status

> "I want to become healthier, but I am *definitely* not eating boiled broccoli every evening."

Psychographics reveal the **motivation behind behaviour** — often more powerful than demographics alone.

Segmentation Lens #4: Behavioural



What Do They Actually Do?

- Usage & frequency
- Benefits sought
- Brand loyalty
- Purchase occasion
- Purchase behaviour

Example for FitFataak: People who regularly snack between 4–6 PM at the office.

Behavioural data often tells you the *why* behind the purchase — and that's what great marketing taps into.



Demographics Tell You Who. Behaviour Tells You Why.

Meet Aman

30 | Delhi | ₹15L salary | Male

Works out 6 days a week. Reads protein labels.

Meet Karan

30 | Delhi | ₹15L salary | Male

Primary exercise: finding the TV remote.

Demographically **identical**. Their snack motivations? Completely different.

Demographics are useful. But motivations, needs, and behaviours produce much richer marketing insight.

Indian Example: A Food-Delivery Platform

Same platform. Wildly different motivations. Same product, five completely different customers.



Convenience Seekers

"I'm tired. Just send food."



Deal Hunters

"₹250 biryani? Show me the coupon first."



Food Explorers

"Let's try Korean food tonight."



Family Orderers

"Six people. Four cuisines. God save the delivery partner."



Late-Night Users

"1:17 AM and momos have suddenly become essential."

Different motivations → Different offers, creatives, notifications, and messages.

Good Segments Need to Be Useful

Don't create segments just because Excel allows it. A useful segment should pass five tests:

1

Measurable

Can we estimate its size?

2

Substantial

Is the opportunity worth pursuing?

3

Reachable

Can we actually get to these customers?

4

Differentiable

Does this group behave differently from others?

5

Actionable

Can we do something differently for them?

Bad Segmentation

> "People aged 24 years 7 months to 26 years 2 months living exactly 3.7 km from Cyber Hub."

Very specific. Also completely useless.

The Real Goal of Segmentation

Identify groups whose **needs, motivations, and behaviours** are meaningfully different — not groups that are merely narrow.

Precision ≠ Insight. The purpose isn't the narrowest segment. It's the most *useful* one.

Targeting: Now You Have to Choose

FitFataak discovers four possible audiences. Could it eventually serve all four? Sure. Should it communicate identically to all four? **No.**

Segment	Primary Need	Implication
College students	Cheap + tasty	Price & fun messaging
Gym users	Protein	Performance messaging
Office professionals	Healthier evening snack	Occasion + guilt-free messaging
Parents	Better snack for children	Safety + nutrition messaging

Each audience needs a different message, creative, channel, and price logic.

How Do You Choose a Target?

Use a simple attractiveness framework. Evaluate each segment across six criteria before committing your budget.



Market Size

Are there enough customers to build a viable business?



Problem Intensity

How strongly do they need a solution?



Willingness to Pay

Will they actually spend?



Reachability

Can we find them efficiently on the right channels?



Competitive Intensity

How crowded is this space?



Brand & Product Fit

Can we genuinely solve their problem?

A Simple Targeting Scorecard

Score each segment across your criteria. These aren't divine truths — the exercise forces the right discussion.

Criteria	Students	Gym Users	Office Professionals
Market size	5	3	5
Problem intensity	3	5	4
Willingness to pay	2	4	4
Reachability	5	4	5
Brand fit	3	5	5

A framework is not an **answer machine**. It's a **thinking machine**.



Target Audience ≠ Buyer Persona

Target Audience

A broader group definition.

"Urban working professionals aged 25–40 who are health-conscious and regularly snack during office hours."

Meet Hungry Harsh 👋

Age 31. Works in Gurgaon. Gets hungry at 4:30 PM. Has joined a gym three times. Currently attending for the fourth time. Wants healthier food. Will not sacrifice taste.

Personas help us visualise the **human behind the spreadsheet**.

Go Beyond Age, Gender and Salary

A strong customer profile answers five things — and for FitFataak, each has a real answer.

WHO?

Urban working professional, 25–40, health-conscious.

GOAL?

Eat healthier without giving up enjoyment.

PAIN?

Healthy snacks often taste boring.

OBJECTION?

₹60 feels expensive vs. regular namkeen.

TRIGGER?

4 PM hunger — the meeting between lunch and dinner.

That information is far more actionable than: *Male, 25–35.*

Positioning Begins Where Targeting Ends

Now we know who we want. Next question:

Why should they choose us?

Customers don't evaluate your product in isolation. FitFataak isn't only competing with protein snack brands. It competes with **anything solving the same customer problem**.

Samosa	**Chips**	**Biscuits**
Protein Bars	**Ordering Food**	

Points of Parity vs Points of Difference

Points of Parity (POP)

Things customers expect **every** player in the category to provide. For a food-delivery app: restaurant selection, payment, tracking, delivery.

These won't differentiate you — but without them, you can't compete.

Points of Difference (POD)

Associations customers should particularly connect with *your* brand.

- Faster / More reliable
- More affordable / Premium
- More specialised
- Better service or availability

What do you offer that matters to the customer and is **not easily interchangeable**?

Points of Difference — Going Deeper



The Key Question

What do we offer that:

- Matters to the customer
- Is not what every competitor says
- Can we credibly deliver?

Generic points of difference — "great quality," "best service" — are not actually differentiating. They're table stakes in disguise.

Your POD must be **specific enough** that a competitor cannot copy it with a straight face.

Positioning Is About Owning an Idea

Airline A

> "Flights across India."

Descriptive. Forgettable. Anyone could say this.

Airline B

> "Reliable low-cost flying with a simple no-frills experience."

Creates a clear, ownable idea. You know exactly what you're getting.

Positioning isn't "we are better." It's: **"What particular idea do we want customers to associate with us?"**

Framework: Value Proposition Canvas Lite



Connect Product to Need

Jobs: What is Hungry Harsh trying to accomplish? Stop evening hunger.

Pains: Samosa feels unhealthy. Protein bar is expensive. Fruit isn't satisfying. Healthy snacks taste boring.

Gains: Tasty, filling, protein-rich, convenient, and reasonably priced.

Now connect your product directly to each of these needs — that's your value proposition foundation.

Feature vs Benefit vs Value

These get confused constantly. Most marketing stalls at "feature" and never reaches customer value.



Feature **Benefit** **Value**

Customers rarely buy a feature in isolation. They buy the **outcome created by the feature**.

The "So What?" Test

Whenever your brand says something, keep asking — until you reach something the customer actually values.

1

"We use AI."

So what?

2

"It analyses customer behaviour."

So what?

3

"You get personalised recommendations."

So what?

4

"You spend less time searching."

Now we're getting closer to value. ✓

Build a Simple Value Proposition

> **For [target audience] who [have a problem/need], our [product] provides [benefit] because [reason to believe].**

For FitFataak:

For **busy working professionals** who get hungry between lunch and dinner but want to eat healthier, **FitFataak** offers tasty, protein-rich Indian snacks that provide an alternative to typical office junk food.

This single statement carries audience, occasion, benefit, and differentiation. It becomes the brief for every piece of marketing you create.

Weak vs Strong Value Proposition

Weak ❌

> "India's innovative premium healthy snacking experience."

Sounds impressive. Means very little. Who is it for? What problem does it solve? What makes it different?

Stronger ✓

> "Protein-rich Indian snacks for people who want healthier evening snacking without giving up taste."

Now we understand: audience, occasion, need, benefit, and differentiation — all in one sentence.

Differentiation Must Pass Three Tests

Relevant

Does the customer actually care? "Our packet uses Helvetica." Wonderful. Nobody cares.

Defensible

Can a competitor copy it tomorrow? "10% discount." Probably. That's not a differentiator — it's a promotion.

Credible

Will people believe it? "Eat one packet and become Virat Kohli." Potentially ambitious.

Aim for differentiation that is: **Relevant + Credible + Difficult to Replicate.**

Positioning ≠ Tagline

Positioning

The **strategic idea** you want to own. Built from your STP work. Internal compass for all decisions.

Value Proposition

Why the customer should choose you. Specific, rational, audience-facing.

Tagline

A **creative expression** of your idea. The last thing you write, not the first.



Don't start with "let's brainstorm taglines" before answering: **"Who exactly are we trying to convince?"**



Bring AI Into Customer Understanding

AI works well as a **Customer Research Sounding Board**. Use it to generate hypotheses, explore motivations, challenge assumptions, and stress-test positioning.

Where AI Helps

- Generate customer segments
- Surface potential objections
- Identify missing questions
- Challenge your assumptions

The Limit

⚠ AI output is **not automatically customer truth**. Use AI to improve your thinking. Use actual customers and data to validate it.

Bad AI Prompt

"Who is my target audience for healthy snacks?"

Potential AI Answer:

- **Millennials**
- **Gen Z**
- **Fitness Enthusiasts**
- **Health-Conscious Customers**

Congratulations. You have successfully created a PowerPoint from 2017. Garbage in, garbage out — the prompt had no context, no constraints, no strategic questions.

Better AI Prompt

"Act as a consumer strategy consultant. I am launching a ₹60 baked Indian snack containing 15g protein, primarily sold online in metro Indian cities. Generate five plausible customer segments. For each, explain the need, purchase trigger, key objection, current alternatives and why they may or may not choose my product."

Now AI has real context:

Price

₹60

Geography

Metro India

Product

Baked, 15g protein

Category

Online snacks

Strategic questions

Objections + alternatives

Don't Ask AI to Agree With You

Turn AI into a sparring partner — not a cheerleader. These four prompts will do more for your strategy than 10 "is my idea good?" questions.

1. **"Act like a sceptical customer. Give me 5 reasons you would not buy this."**
2. **"Act like my biggest competitor. Attack my positioning."**
3. **"What assumptions am I making about this customer that could be wrong?"**
4. **"What evidence should I collect before investing in this audience?"**

Build an AI Customer Council

Ask AI to evaluate your proposition from multiple customer perspectives simultaneously — this may reveal which audience resonates most.

Price-Sensitive Office Employee

What appeals? What doesn't? Biggest objection?

Fitness Enthusiast

What appeals? What doesn't? Biggest objection?

Working Parent

What appeals? What doesn't? Biggest objection?

College Student

What appeals? What doesn't? Biggest objection?

This is still a **hypothesis to validate** — not a substitute for talking to real customers.

AI → Hypothesis → Validation

Don't Do This ❌

AI says ideal customer = Bangalore professionals aged 28.

↓

Launch ₹2 crore campaign.

Do This Instead ✓

AI generates a **hypothesis**. Then validate it through:

- Customer interviews
- Surveys & search behaviour
- CRM & website analytics
- Social listening
- Campaign response data
- Purchase behaviour

Bringing the Entire Strategy Together



Market

Segmentation

Targeting

Insight

Differentiation

QUIZ TIME

Question 1

What is the primary purpose of segmentation?

A

To create as many customer groups as possible

B ✓

To divide a market into groups with meaningfully different needs or behaviours

C

To reduce the price of the product

D

To select advertising platforms

QUIZ TIME

Question 2

Which is an example of behavioural segmentation?

A

Customers aged 25–35

B

Customers living in Delhi and Mumbai

C ✓

Customers who order food after 10 PM at least twice a week

D

Customers earning more than ₹10 lakh annually

QUIZ TIME

Question 3

A company identifies four customer groups but decides to primarily serve working professionals. Which STP stage is this?

A

Segmentation

B ✓

Targeting

C

Positioning

D

Personalisation

QUIZ TIME

Question 4

Which is the strongest example of a customer insight?

A

Customers are aged 25–40

B

Customers live in metro cities

C ✓

Customers often get hungry around 4 PM but avoid regular snacks because they perceive them as unhealthy

D

Customers own smartphones

QUIZ TIME

Question 5

Which statement best describes a Point of Difference?

A

A feature every competitor must offer

B ✓

Something that matters to customers and helps distinguish the brand

C

The company's annual revenue

D

A demographic characteristic of the audience

Rapid Revision: STP in 60 Seconds

Divide → Choose → Own

Segmentation?	Targeting?	Positioning?
Divide the market.	Choose the market.	Own an idea in that market.

Segmentation Cheat Sheet

D-G-P-B

D — Demographic

Who are they?

G — Geographic

Where are they?

P — Psychographic

How do they think?

B — Behavioural

What do they do?

Don't blindly use all four. Ask: **Which characteristic actually changes purchase behaviour?**

Targeting Cheat Sheet

Don't only ask "Is this market big?" Dig deeper before committing your resources.

- **Is the problem strong enough?**
- **Will they actually pay?**
- **Can we reach them efficiently?**
- **Can we genuinely solve their problem?**
- **Can we win against current alternatives?**

Big market ≠ automatically good target market.

Customer Profile Cheat Sheet

WHO

Who are they? Demographics, lifestyle, context.

GOAL

What are they trying to achieve in their life or work?

PAIN

What frustrates them today? What's broken?

OBJECTION

Why might they not buy — even if they need it?

TRIGGER

What makes them act? The moment of decision.

Differentiation Cheat Sheet

POP — Points of Parity

Things you need just to compete. The minimum expectation. Without them, you're not in the game.

POD — Points of Difference

What helps the customer choose *you* over everyone else.

Then Test Your POD:

Relevant?

Does the customer care?

Credible?

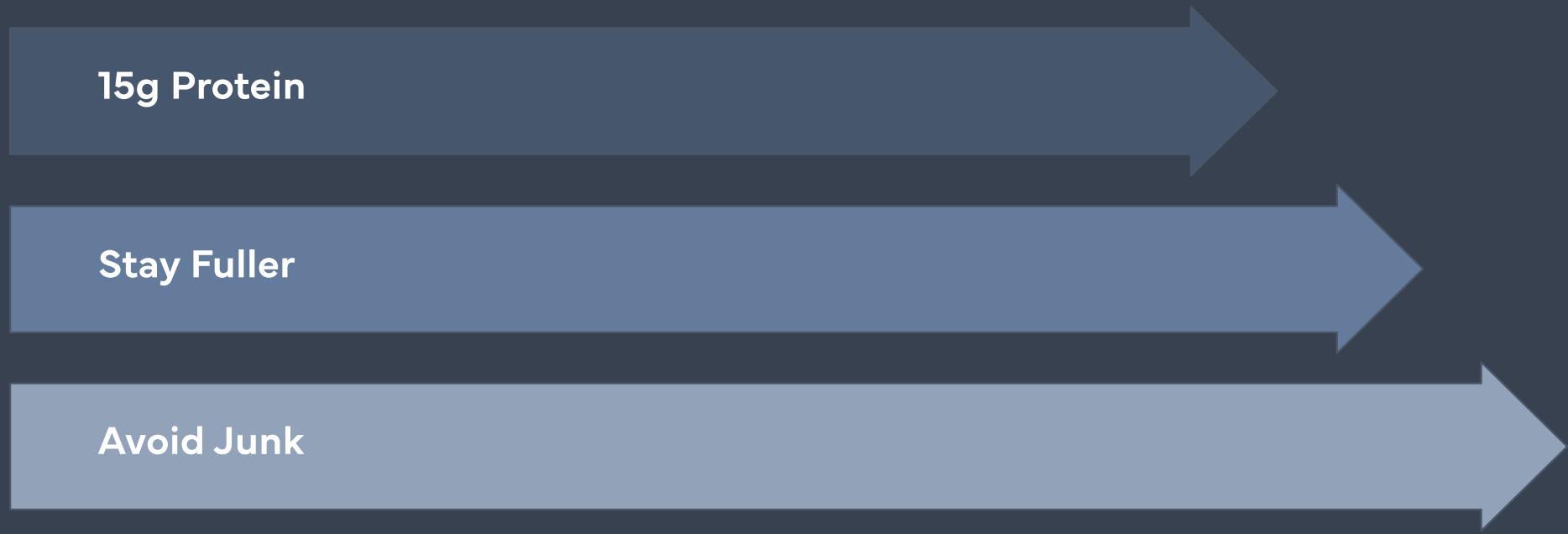
Will they believe it?

Defensible?

Hard to copy?

Value Proposition Cheat Sheet

For [customer] who [problem], we provide [benefit] because [reason to believe].



Always translate features into benefits, and benefits into the lived outcome the customer actually cares about.

AI Cheat Sheet

Explore → Challenge → Compare → Refine

Use AI as a sounding board at every stage of strategy development. But never shortcut to:

> Ask → Believe → Spend ₹5 crore

AI is a thinking partner, not your customer research department. Always validate with real people and real data.

Questions? Doubts?
Disagreements?

This is the only time when "But sir..." is officially encouraged.

😄





Now We Know the Customer. What Do We Say?

You know your target audience, their pain, their triggers, your differentiation, and your value proposition. Excellent. And then someone writes:

> "Empowering tomorrow through next-generation customer-centric innovation."

And the entire strategy dies peacefully. Because customers never see your STP presentation. They see ads, landing pages, emails, WhatsApp messages, and social posts.

Eventually, **strategy becomes words**. That's what copywriting is for.

Copywriting Is Not "Writing Nicely"

Copy Has a Job

- Getting attention
- Creating curiosity
- Explaining value
- Reducing objections
- Building trust
- Driving action



Copy is not decoration. It is a **commercial tool**. A beautiful sentence that communicates nothing is poor marketing.

The Wrong Brief = The Wrong Output

Our FitFataak target: busy office professionals with 4 PM hunger. Indian taste + protein + convenience. Now ask AI: *"Write a tagline for FitFataak."*

AI might give you:

> "Fuel Your Life."

Sounds nice. Could also advertise protein powder, petrol, shoes, energy drinks, gyms, or motivational seminars.

Protein powder	**Petrol**
Running shoes	**Energy drinks**

The problem isn't AI. The problem is the **brief**.

Your STP Output Becomes AI Input

Instead of "Give me taglines," try this:

"FitFataak is a protein-rich baked Indian snack for urban working professionals aged roughly 25–40 who get hungry around 4 PM but want to avoid oily office snacks. The brand should feel witty, modern and relatable rather than preachy or fitness-obsessed. Our differentiation is familiar Indian taste combined with better nutrition. Generate 10 short tagline options."

WHO?

Working professionals

PROBLEM?

Evening hunger

ALTERNATIVE?

Oily snacks

DIFF?

Indian taste + protein

TONE?

Witty, relatable

Think of AI Like a Junior Copywriter

Without a Brief

You: "Write something."

AI: "For whom?"

You: "People."

AI: "What are we selling?"

You: "Product."

Then you complain: "Creative team is useless."



AI needs a **creative brief**, not magic words. This is how many marketers prompt AI — and then wonder why results disappoint.

The AI Copy Brief

Give AI six inputs every time — and watch the output quality transform.

AUDIENCE

Who are we talking to?

PROBLEM

What are they struggling with?

PROMISE

What outcome do we offer?

PROOF

Why should they believe us?

TONE

How should we sound?

ACTION

What should the audience do?

A-P-P-P-T-A. Terrible acronym. Excellent framework. Even the acronym proves why human copywriters are still required.

FitFataak Creative Brief

Audience

Busy working professionals

Problem

4 PM hunger + unhealthy office snacks

Promise

Tasty, protein-rich evening snacking

Proof

15g protein, baked, Indian flavours

Tone

Witty, modern, playful

Action

Try / order FitFataak

With this brief loaded, AI can now generate far more focused, relevant, on-brand copy options.

Generating Taglines With AI

Weak Prompt ❌

> "Give me a tagline."

One direction. Same idea repeated 15 times. No creative variety.

Better Prompt ✓

> "Generate 15 tagline options. Keep them below 6 words. Avoid generic words like innovation, wellness, and healthy living. Give me 5 playful, 5 benefit-led, and 5 punchy options."

You want **creative breadth** — not 15 versions of the same sentence. Variety gives you something to choose from.

AI Output Is Raw Material

Possible outputs from the FitFataak brief — and what each one actually does:

"Protein Meets Namkeen."

Communicates product/category tension. Good for awareness.

"Beat the 4 PM Hunger."

Owns the occasion. Strong for performance marketing.

"Your Chai Deserves Better."

High relatability, lower product explanation. Good for social.

There isn't always one objectively perfect line. The choice depends on brand, audience, objective, and channel.

One Strategy, Multiple Creative Angles

Same product. Same positioning. Five completely different routes into the customer's mind.

Functional

"15g protein for your 4 PM hunger."

Emotional

"Snack without the guilt spiral."

Occasion-led

"Made for the gap between lunch and dinner."

Behavioural

"Skip the samosa. Keep the crunch."

Humorous

"Because your 4 PM hunger has no HR policy."

Tagline vs Landing Page Headline

Tagline

Builds memory, brand identity, and long-term association. Can afford to be evocative, clever, or abstract.

Landing Page Headline

Creates immediate understanding, relevance, and desire to continue. Must answer four questions fast.

What is this?

Is it for me?

Why should I care?

What do I do next?

A visitor asks all four in seconds. Your headline either answers them or loses them.

Weak Landing Page Headline

> "Redefining the Future of Healthy Snacking."

Sounds sophisticated. But ask the four visitor questions:

What are you selling?

Unclear.

Who is it for?

Unclear.

What makes it different?

Unclear.

What should I do?

Unclear.

⊗ Generic headlines that answer nothing cost you the visitor — and the click.

Stronger Landing Page Headline

The Protein-Rich Indian Snack Built for 4 PM Hunger

Baked snacks with 15g protein and familiar Indian flavours, made for busy workdays.

Product ✓

Audience/Context ✓

Occasion ✓

Benefit ✓

Differentiation ✓

Useful Headline Formula #1

> **Outcome + Audience/Occasion + Differentiator**

A Healthier 4 PM Snack Without Giving Up Indian Taste

This formula works because it leads with what the customer gains, grounds it in their specific moment, and immediately signals what makes this different from every other "healthy snack" out there.

Useful Headline Formula #2

Problem + Promise

Hungry Between Lunch and Dinner? Meet Your Better Office Snack.

The question opens a loop — if you're that person, you lean in. The promise closes it. Problem + Promise is one of the most reliable formulas in direct-response copywriting.

Useful Headline Formula #3

Category + Difference

Protein-Rich Namkeen Without the Deep-Fried Regret.

Anchors in the category the customer already knows (namkeen), then immediately pivots to what's different. Give AI different formulas — you'll get different creative territories to explore.

Formulas are starting points. Break them when the content demands it.

Never Ask AI for Only One Option

Weak Ask ❌

> "Give me a headline."

One direction. One idea. No room to choose.

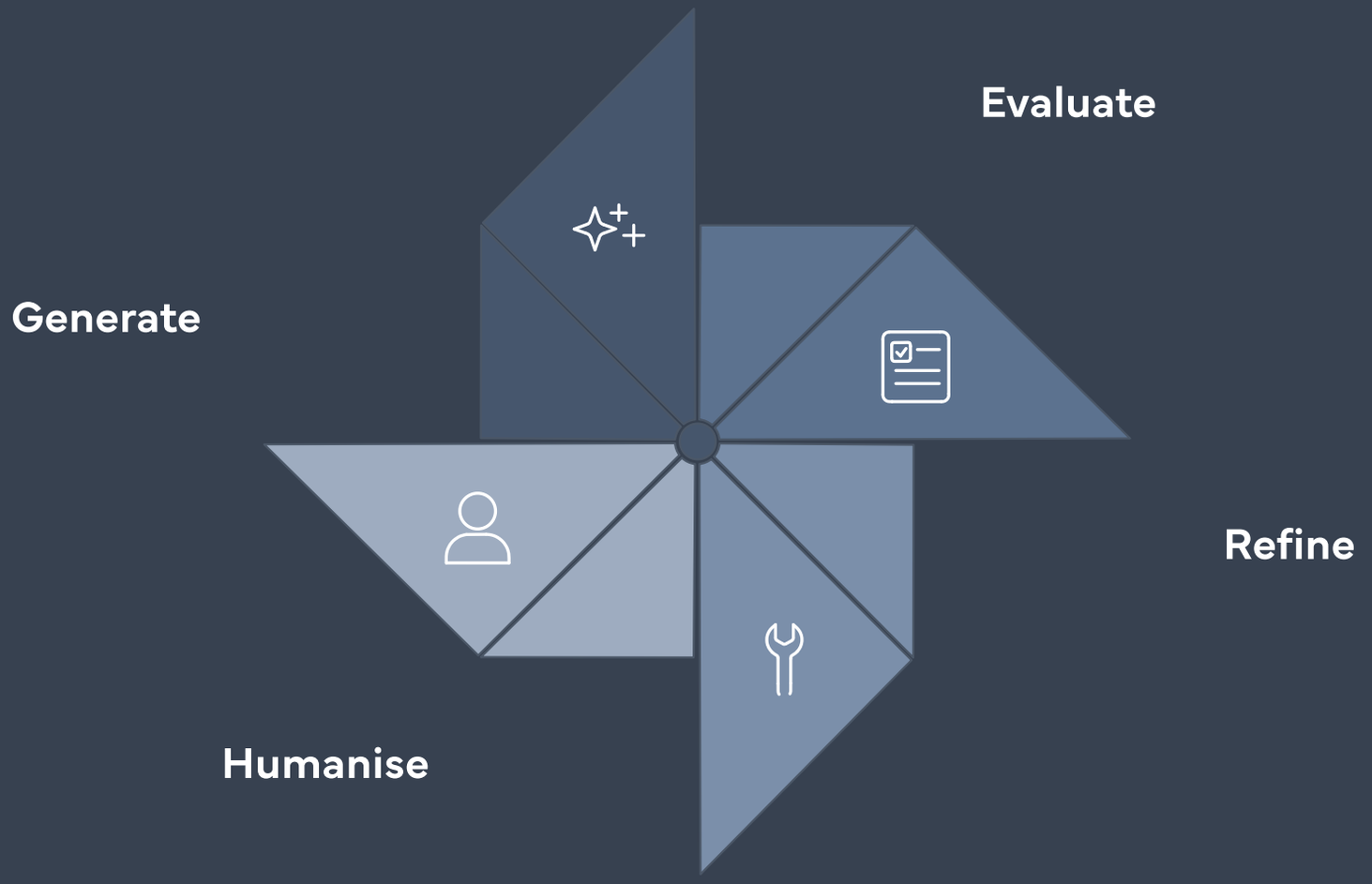
Better Ask ✓

"Generate 15 headlines across 5 routes:

1. Benefit-led
2. Problem-led
3. Humorous
4. Premium
5. Direct-response"

AI is excellent at **generating breadth**. Human judgment decides which direction deserves to survive.

First Draft ≠ Final Copy



AI gives you clay. You still make the pot. Occasionally AI gives you 17 pots nobody asked for.

Evaluate Copy With Three Filters

T-C-R

TONE

Does it sound like our brand? Would our target customer say this?

CLARITY

Will the customer understand it on the first read? No decoding required.

RESONANCE

Will the target audience actually care? Does it connect to their life?

A line can sound good but confuse. Be clear but irrelevant. Be relevant but off-brand. Great copy balances all three.

Tone: When AI Gets It Wrong

Our Brand Should Be:

- Young & witty
- Friendly & playful
- Conversational, not preachy

AI Writes:

> "Experience our scientifically optimised nutritional snacking ecosystem."

The customer asked for namkeen. We gave them a consulting presentation.

⊗ Wrong tone doesn't just sound off — it actively erodes trust with the audience you worked hard to understand.

Give AI Better Tone Instructions

Weak ❌

> "Make it friendly."

Vague adjective. AI interprets "friendly" very broadly.

Better ✓

> "Use conversational Indian English. Keep sentences short. Sound like a witty colleague, not a nutrition coach. Avoid jargon, exaggerated claims and preachy health language."

Describe **how the brand behaves** — not merely adjectives. Behaviour is specific. Adjectives are not.

Clarity: The First-Read Test

Weak ❌

> "Optimising everyday consumption through intelligent nutrition."

Three reads required. Customer is already gone.

Better ✓

> "15g protein in your evening snack."

Understood immediately. No decoding. No effort.

You don't get extra marketing points because the customer had to read it three times. **Cleverness should not defeat comprehension.**

The One-Breath Test

Read the copy aloud. If you run out of breath before understanding it — your customer probably ran out of interest.

Useful for ads, headlines, social copy, email subject lines, and mobile landing pages.

Short isn't always better. But unnecessary complexity almost never helps.



Resonance: Harder Than Clarity

Clear, But Cold ❌

> "Our snack contains 15g protein."

True. Clear. Will the audience care? Maybe. But nothing connects it to their life.

Clear AND Resonant ✓

> "Stay full through the last two meetings of the day."

The benefit has entered the customer's actual life. That's resonance.

Resonance comes from reflecting the customer's **situation, language, frustration, and desire**.

Talk About the Target Audience's Reality

Generic ❌

> "A convenient source of nutrition."

Could be said by anyone, about anything.

Resonant ✓

> "For the meeting that somehow got scheduled at 5 PM."

That line doesn't explain the product. It does something more valuable:

"This brand **understands my life.**" That's resonance.

Use AI to Critique AI

After generating headlines, ask:

"Evaluate these options against the target audience and positioning. Review each for clarity, tone fit, relevance, differentiation and risk of sounding generic. Explain weaknesses rather than only giving scores."

⚠ AI evaluating AI is still AI. It can provide perspective. It cannot magically become the customer. Use this as a filter, not a verdict.

Create a More Aggressive Critic

Weak Ask ❌

> "Which headline is best?"

AI will pick one and justify it. Mostly useless.

Better Ask ✓

> "Act as a sceptical senior copy editor. Assume these lines were generated by AI. Identify clichés, generic language, weak claims, tone mismatch, and anything a competitor could easily say."

Now AI has moved from **Generator** to **Critic** — a much more useful role at the refinement stage.

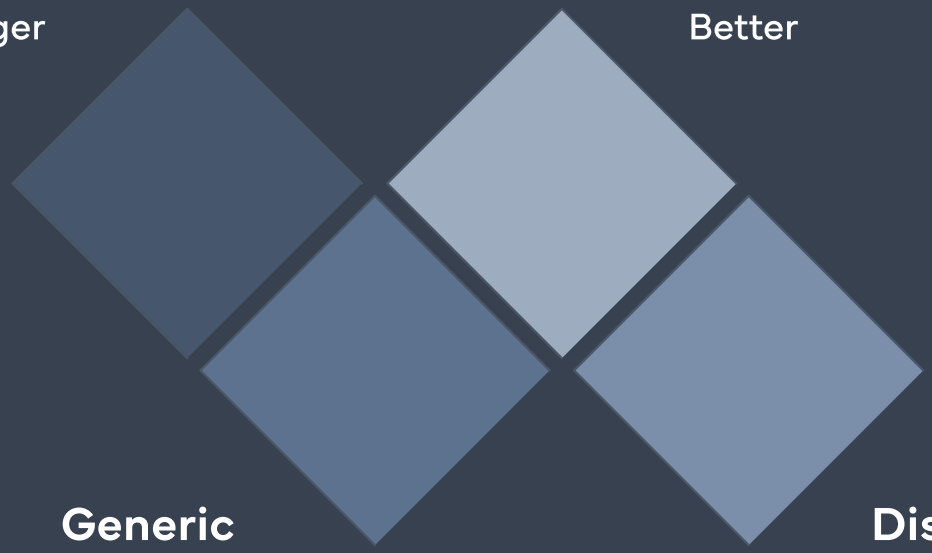
Refine Through Iteration

Specific

A Better Snack for Your 4 PM Hunger

Playful

Your 4 PM Hunger Deserves Better



Generic

A Better Snack for Busy Professionals

Distinctive

Your 4 PM Hunger Deserves 15g Protein

Each round of prompting adds specificity, personality, or product truth. The idea progresses: **Generic → Specific → Distinctive.**

Refinement Often Means Removing Words

AI Version ❌

> "Discover our exciting range of delicious and nutritionally balanced protein-rich snacks specially designed for today's modern busy professionals."

Human Edit ✓

Protein-rich snacks for busy workdays.

Same basic message. A fraction of the words.

Editing is often compression. Every word that doesn't earn its place should be cut.

Recognise Common AI Language

Watch for the AI vocabulary that signals generic output. None of these words are banned — but ask: **would my customer naturally speak like this?**

Unlock	**Elevate**
Transform	**Revolutionise**
Seamless	**Cutting-edge**
Empower	**Game-changing**

If your customer wouldn't say it, don't write it.

The Competitor Test

Remove your brand name. Could your competitor use exactly the same line?

> "Empowering you to live better."

- **Bank**
- **Insurer**
- **Hospital**
- **Fitness app**
- **Food brand**
- **Telecom**

Generic copy often lacks a proprietary truth. If anyone could say it, no one should.

Customer Language Beats Boardroom Language

Boardroom Language ❌

> "We help consumers unlock healthier consumption occasions."

Customer Language ✓

> "I want something tasty at 4 PM that isn't fried."

Your strategy can be complicated internally. Your communication should usually be **simple externally**. Write for the customer's vocabulary, not your own.

Why Human Judgment Still Matters

AI may not fully understand what makes copy right or wrong for your specific brand and moment.

Brand History

Context AI doesn't have

Cultural Nuance

Sarcasm, local references

Competitive Context

What competitors already own

Double Meanings

Sensitivity risks

Company Risk Tolerance

What the brand can credibly claim

Customer Beliefs

What the audience already thinks

The technically cleverest AI line might still be wrong for your brand.

AI Doesn't Sit in Your Customer Meetings

AI Produces:

> "No excuses. Just protein."

Sounds punchy. Energetic. Confident.

But Your Research Says:

Your audience wants healthier food but **actively dislikes hardcore gym culture**. They're tired of being lectured about fitness.

The copy is wrong — not because it's bad writing, but because it misreads the audience.

Human judgment connects information with lived context. That's the irreplaceable skill.

Humans Decide What Is Worth Saying

AI Identifies:

15g protein — the product's functional claim.

AI Leads With:

> "15g protein per pack."

But Research Reveals:

Customers care more about **Indian taste** than protein count.
So the headline becomes:

> "The Healthy Snack That Still Tastes Like a Snack."

AI creates options. **Strategy determines which truth deserves emphasis.**

Human + AI Workflow



Strategy **Generation** **Evaluation** **Refinement** **Selection**

Much stronger than: **Prompt → Publish.**

Don't Ask "Is This Good Copy?"

Good is subjective. Ask the right diagnostic questions instead.

→ Is it clear?

Understood on the first read?

→ Is it specific?

Not something any competitor could say?

→ Is it relevant?

Does the audience recognise themselves?

→ Is it distinctive?

Does it carry a proprietary truth?

→ Is it believable?

Can the brand credibly back it up?

→ Does it drive action?

Does it encourage the desired next step?

Weak Ad vs Strong Ad

Weak ❌

Elevate Your Snacking Journey

Experience next-generation nutrition designed for modern lifestyles.

CTA: Learn More

Improved ✓

Still Hungry at 4 PM?

Get 15g protein with the crunch and Indian flavours you actually enjoy.

CTA: Try FitFataak

Customer situation ✓	**Specific occasion ✓**	**Clear benefit ✓**	**Simpler language ✓**

Strong Ad — Deep Dive



Why the Improved Ad Works

"Still Hungry at 4 PM?" — opens a loop. If you're that person, you stop scrolling.

"15g protein with the crunch and Indian flavours you actually enjoy" — answers the product question, the differentiation, and the taste objection in one sentence.

"Try FitFataak" — clear, low-commitment action. Not "Learn More." Not "Explore." *Try.*

Strategy Into Landing Page

Headline

"Your 4 PM Hunger Deserves Better Than Another Samosa"

Sub-head

Baked Indian snacks with 15g protein for busy office days.

Proof Points

Baked, not deep-fried · 15g protein · Familiar Indian flavours

CTA

"Choose Your Flavour" — specific, action-oriented, low friction.

Strategy has now become copy. Every element connects back to the customer insight.

Strategy Into Email

Subject Line

> "The 4 PM hunger problem"

Identifies the problem without solving it yet. Creates curiosity. Gets the open.

Opening

> "By 4 PM, lunch is history and dinner is still far away. That's normally when the samosa starts looking like a strategic decision."

Then introduce the product. **Story before product. Context before claim.**



Bringing It All Together

Who to speak to?

Answered by STP.

Why should they choose us?

Answered by positioning + value proposition.

What exactly should we say?

Answered by great copywriting.

Great marketing copy sits at the intersection of **strategy, customer understanding, creativity, and human judgment**. AI accelerates the process. It does not replace the marketer.

QUIZ TIME

Question 1

Why does STP output improve AI-generated marketing copy?

A

Because AI requires demographic information to function

B ✓

Because STP gives AI context about the audience, need, and positioning

C

Because STP automatically generates headlines

D

Because AI cannot create copy without segmentation

QUIZ TIME

Question 2

Which prompt is most likely to generate useful copy?

A

"Write a tagline."

B

"Write a cool tagline for a snack."

C ✓

"Write 10 short taglines for a protein-rich Indian snack aimed at busy office workers who get hungry around 4 PM. Keep the tone witty and avoid generic health language."

D

"Give me marketing ideas."

QUIZ TIME

Question 3

The headline "Transforming nutrition through intelligent snack innovation" — what is its biggest weakness?

A

It is too short

B ✓

It may lack clarity and sound generic — any competitor could say it

C

It contains the word "nutrition"

D

It doesn't contain a discount

QUIZ TIME

Question 4

Which line demonstrates the strongest audience resonance?

A

"We use high-quality ingredients."

B

"15 grams of protein per pack."

C ✓

"Stay full through the meeting that somehow got scheduled at 5 PM."

D

"Available in multiple flavours."

QUIZ TIME

Question 5

Which is the best role for AI in copywriting?

A

Produce final copy and publish it without review

B

Replace customer research entirely

C ✓

Generate, critique, and refine options while humans provide strategic judgment

D

Independently decide brand positioning

Rapid Revision: Start With Strategy

Before prompting AI, make sure you can answer these five questions. If you can't, the output will be generic.

WHO

Target audience — specific, not "everyone."

PROBLEM

What matters to them right now?

VALUE

Why should they choose us over alternatives?

TONE

How should we sound to this audience?

ACTION

What do we want them to do next?

Then prompt. Strategy comes first — always.

Remember T-C-R

TONE · CLARITY · RESONANCE

TONE

Does it sound like us?

CLARITY

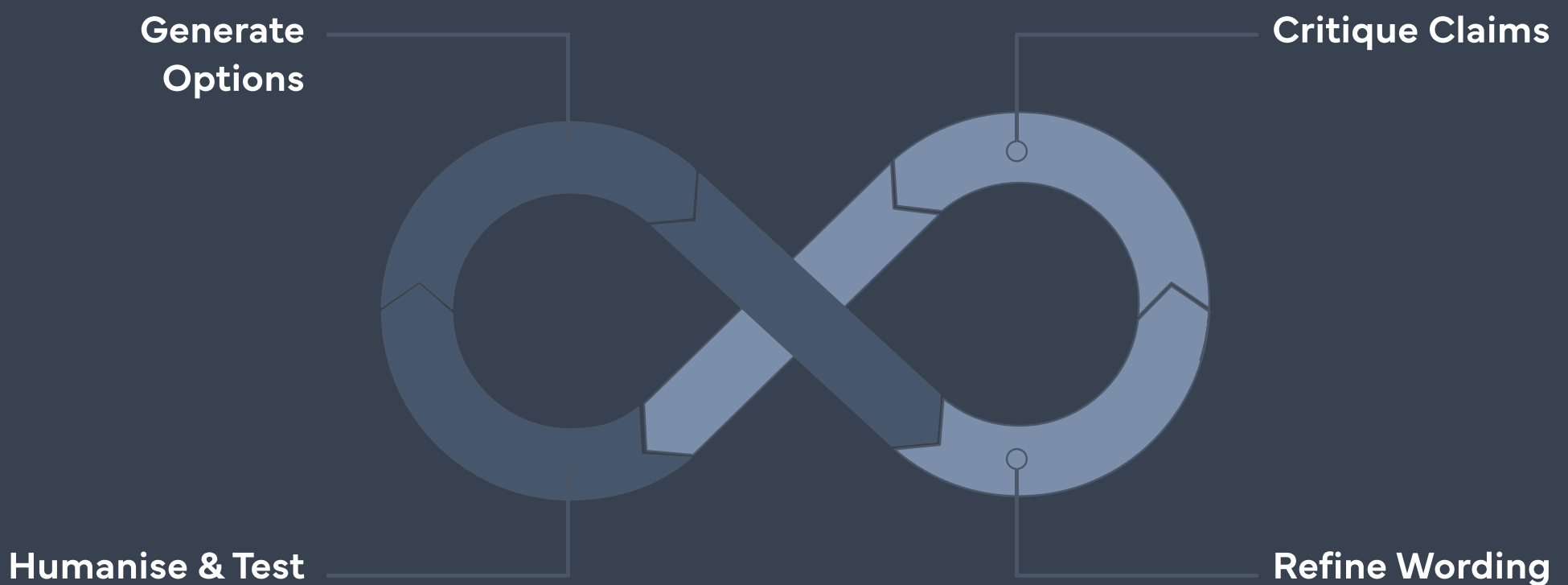
Will they understand it on the first read?

RESONANCE

Will they actually care?

If any one fails: **Refine.**

The Copy Refinement Loop



Final Copy Checklist

Before anything goes live, run through this list. If half the answers are no — the copy is not ready.

- [ ] Could a competitor say exactly the same thing?
- [ ] Is there unnecessary jargon?
- [ ] Is the benefit obvious to a new reader?
- [ ] Does the target audience recognise itself?
- [ ] Is there one clear, central message?
- [ ] Is the claim believable?
- [ ] Is the CTA clear and specific?
- [ ] Does it sound like a human wrote it?

Great copy earns its place by doing a job. Run the checklist every time — no exceptions.